

Unit 13b: Earth's Tectonic Plates

Reading: pages 191–198 · 20 points · 15 minutes · Closed book

Name _____

Date _____

Score / 20

Answer every question. For multiple choice, circle the single best answer. Write short answers in complete sentences.

Part A · Multiple Choice

6 questions × 2 points = 12 points

1. Earth's tectonic plates are made up of
 - a) the asthenosphere
 - b) the entire mantle
 - c) the crust only
 - d) the lithosphere

2. Tectonic plates move at a rate of roughly
 - a) a few centimeters per year
 - b) a few meters per year
 - c) a few kilometers per year
 - d) a few millimeters per century

3. At a divergent boundary between two oceanic plates, you would expect to find
 - a) a deep-sea trench
 - b) a mid-ocean ridge with a rift valley between the plates
 - c) a continental volcanic arc
 - d) a transform fault

4. When an oceanic plate converges with a continental plate, the oceanic plate subducts because
 - a) it is denser
 - b) it is thicker
 - c) it is moving faster
 - d) it is older

5. The Himalayan mountains were formed by
 - a) ocean-to-continent convergence
 - b) continent-to-continent convergence
 - c) divergence
 - d) transform motion

6. The San Andreas Fault is an example of a
- a) divergent boundary
 - b) convergent boundary
 - c) transform boundary
 - d) hotspot

Part B · True or False

2 questions × 1 point = 2 points

7. Hotspot volcanoes form in lines, with the youngest volcano sitting directly above the hotspot.
TRUE / FALSE
8. Most geologic activity takes place in the middle of tectonic plates rather than at their boundaries.
TRUE / FALSE

Part C · Short Answer

2 questions × 3 points = 6 points

9. Explain how earthquake epicenters allowed scientists to map the edges of Earth's tectonic plates.
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10. A divergent boundary opening within a continent passes through several stages. Describe that sequence and give the example the text uses for each stage.
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